Table 3.2 Food Purchase Chart				
S.No.	Types of food	Shelf life	Examples of food item	Frequency
1	Perishable	Short Life Liable to spoil or decay	Meat, fish, poultry, dairy products	Daily basis
2	Semi perishable	Limited shelf life	Potatoes, Onions, Garlic	Weekly basis
3	Non-perishable	Longer shelf life	Cereals, Flours, Spices, Canned foods, Nuts	Monthly basis

"Purchasing is the process of getting the right product into facility at the right time and place, plus the amount of goods at the right price and source".

Every production operation has different purchasing procedures. But there is one rule that should always be followed.

Buy only as much as it is needed until the next delivery.

This will ensure that foods stay fresh and will create a high inventory turnover.

a. Important Functions of Food Purchasing in a Food Service

- Help in menu planning.
- Aid to predict profitability of an establishment.
- Evaluate the quality of the products.
- Identify the suppliers potential.
- Maintain customer satisfaction.
- Know the latest forms of technology, products or services available in the market place.

b. Methods of Purchasing

Depending on the type of establishment, the following purchasing methods are used.



▲ Figure 3.3 Methods of Purchasing

i. Direct Delivery

- Involves direct delivery of food and beverages from the manufacturers to the food service operation.

ii. Formal Buying

- Quotations are invited from the sellers, bids are made and the best one is selected.
- Generally adopted by large catering establishments.

iii. Wholesale Buying

- Contract is signed with a wholesaler for purchase of goods at a specific price for a future period.
- Suitable for large scale food service operation.

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